

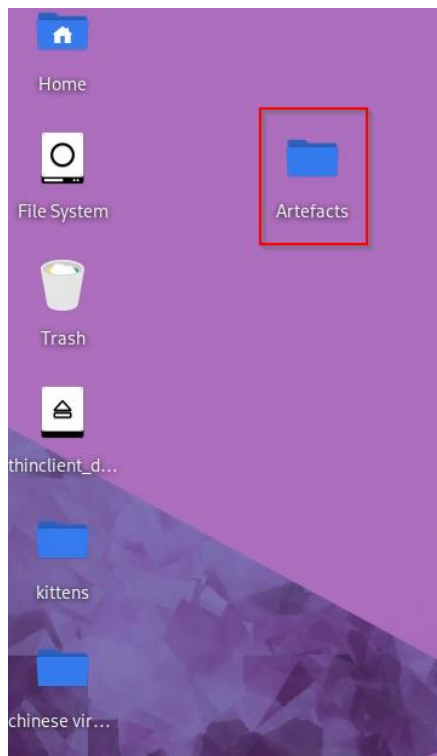
Forensic Evidence Handling Standard

BHB Capstone 2026

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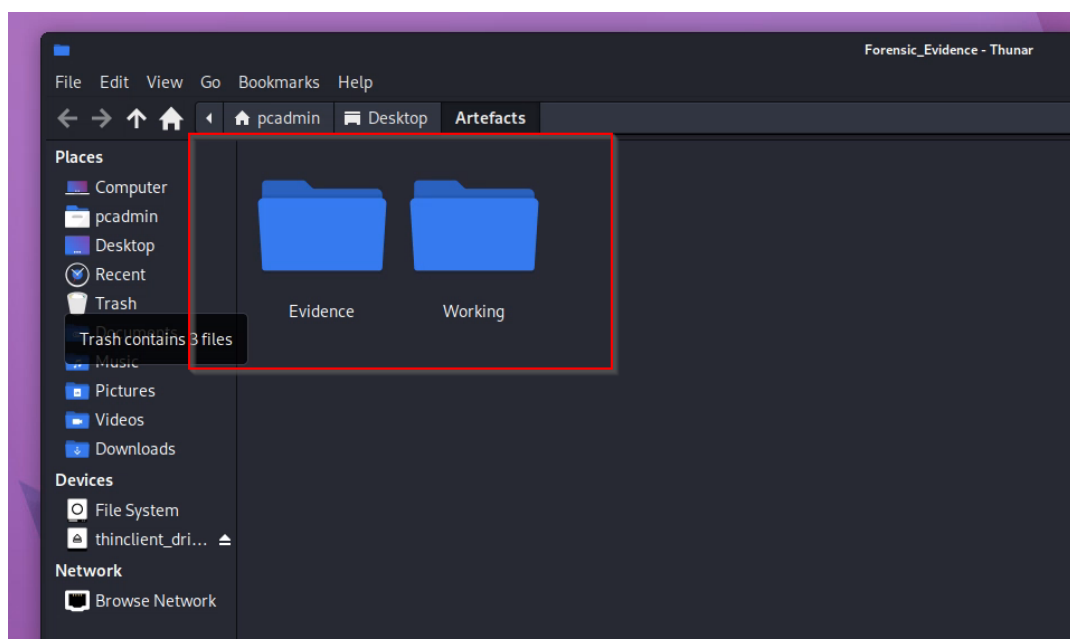
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Guide to Evidence Handling

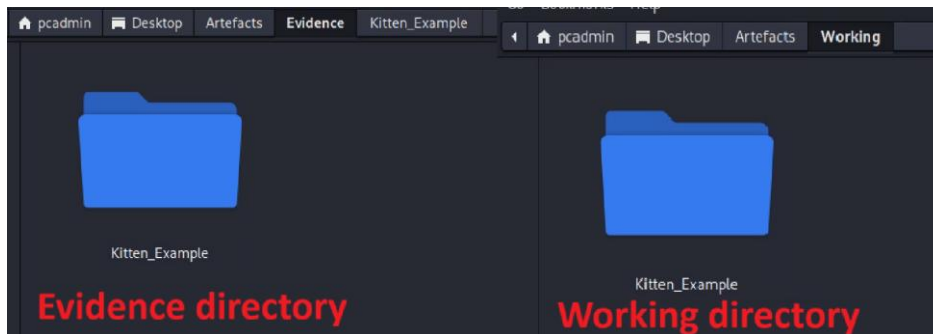


1. On the desktop you will find a folder called Artefacts, this is the directory that you will find the working and evidence folders. If this folder does not exist, you are using an account on the PC that I have not created the folders on and so I ask that you make the folders for steps 1 and 2.

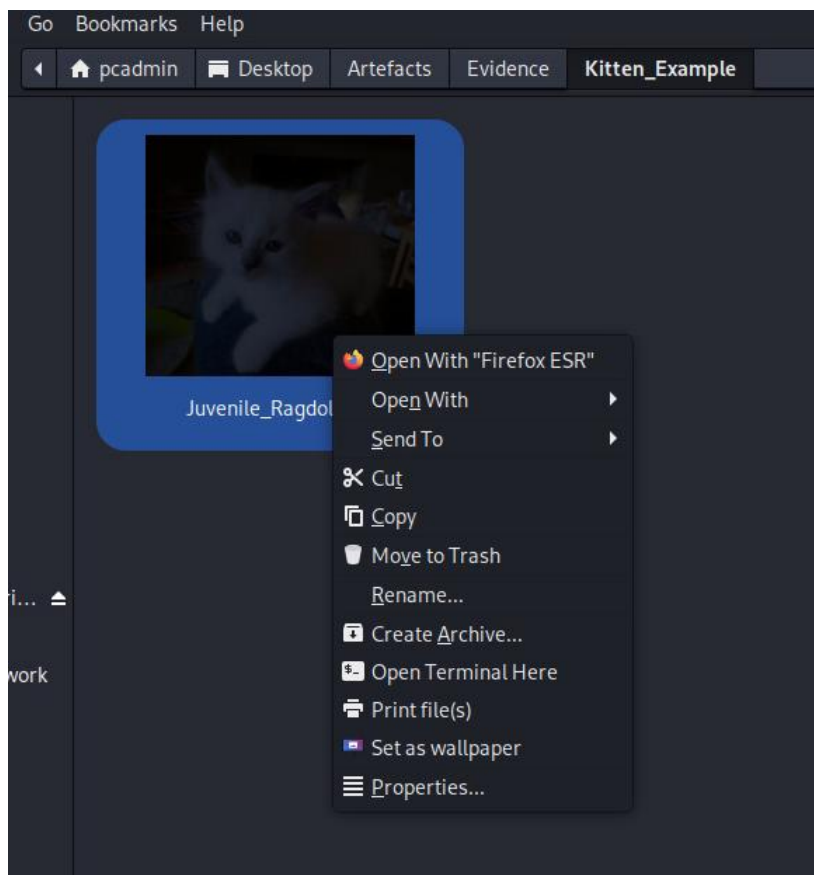
2. Inside Artefacts is the Evidence and Working directories. When evidence is collected, it needs to be sorted and stored in the **evidence** directory.



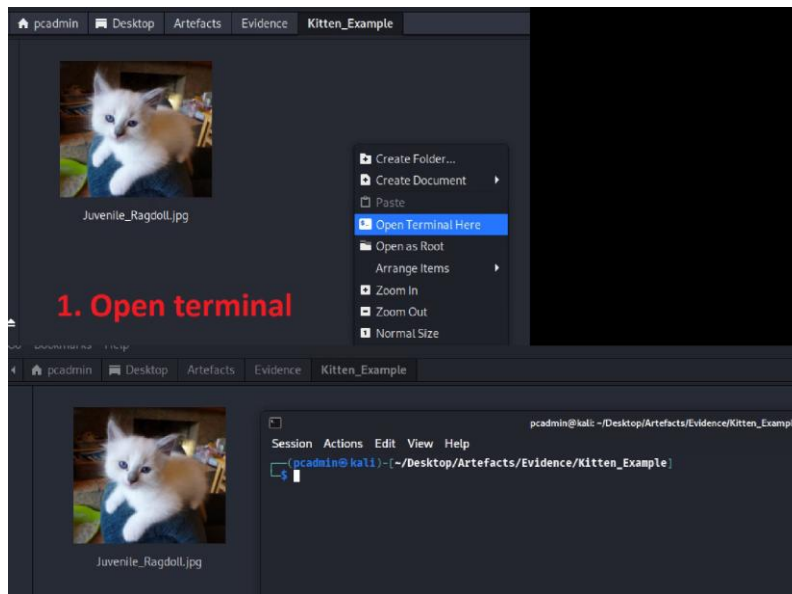
- Evidence in both the working and evidence directories needs to be categorised into its own unique folder that is labelled properly. Please create a folder when you are working on something new.



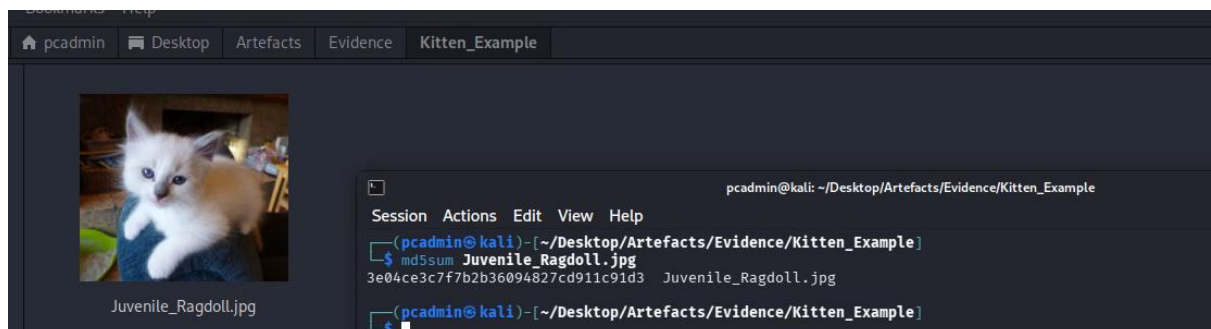
- Copy the evidence you want to work on INTO the working directory (otherwise you'll have to change the rwx settings again)



5. Go back to the evidence directory and open a terminal inside of your evidence folder.

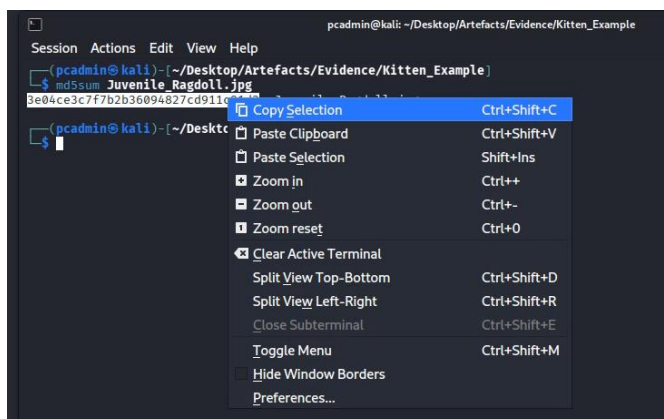


6. In the terminal, use md5sum to create a hash of the evidence.



Command: md5sum (evidence name)

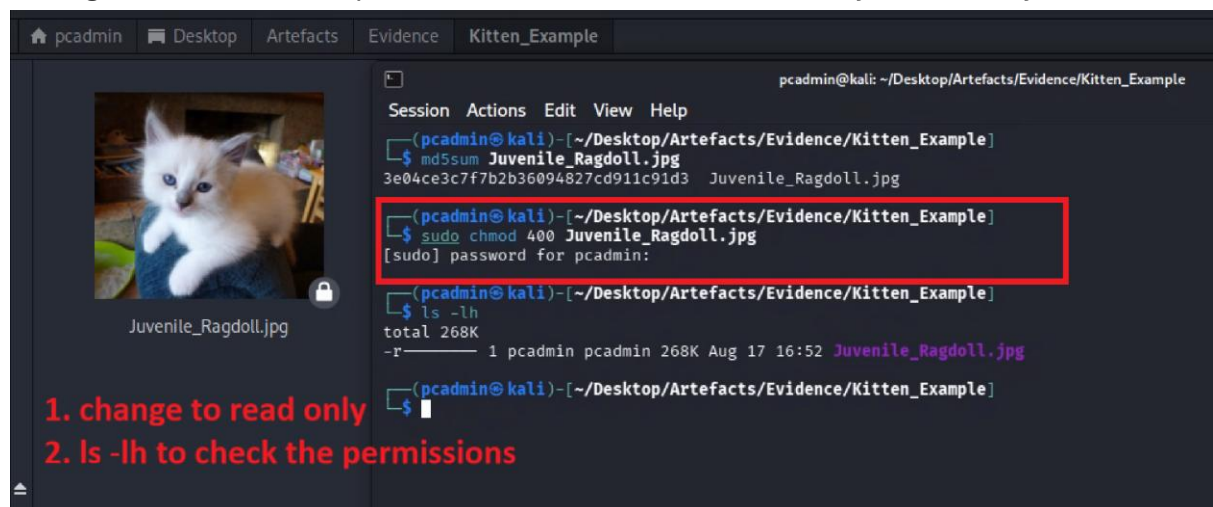
By selecting the hash, click copy selection and then then you will be able to make a record of the hash.



- In the “Evidence Handling Record” document (it is an excel spreadsheet and is a separate document) that is available in the local git repository after you pull, **make a new record for the piece of evidence – do not make duplicate records**

Evidence ID	Evidence Name / filename	Evidence Location	PC Login (username)	Evidence / File Type	MD5 Hash
e_000(example)	Juvenile_Ragdoll.jpg	/home/pcadmin/Desktop/Artefacts/Evidence/Kitten_Example	pcadmin	jpg	3e04ce3c777b2b36094827cd911c91d3
e_001					

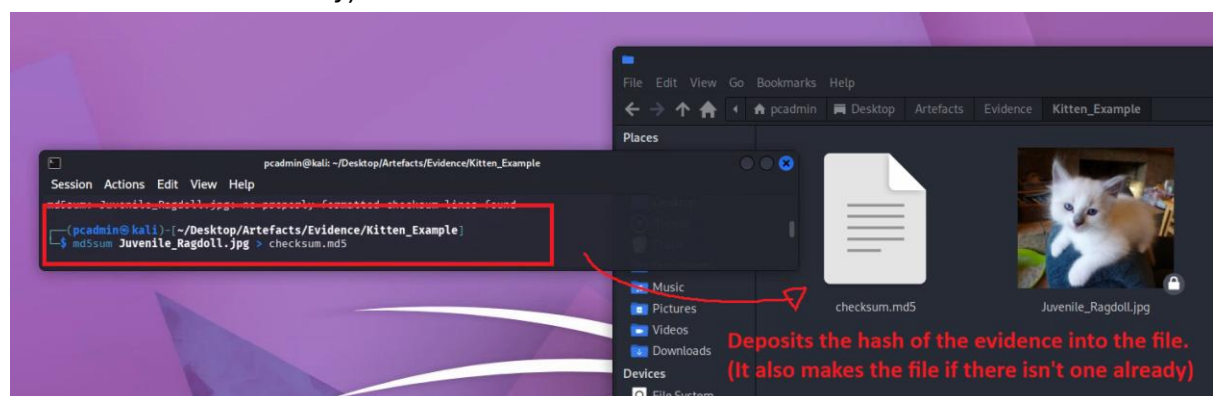
- Change the evidence file permissions in the Evidence directory to read only



sudo chmod 400 (filename)

ls- lh

- Deposit the hash file into the checksum file. (Check that there is a checksum file in the evidence directory).



A checksum file is essentially a text document that contains and stores the hashes of all the evidence that you put into it. When checking the hashes, it compares the hashes stored in it to the hash of the evidence to confirm that it is still the same.

In the command below, replace “Juvenile_Ragdoll.jpg” with the name of the evidence you are trying to hash.

```
md5sum Juvenile_Ragdoll.jpg > checksum.md5
```

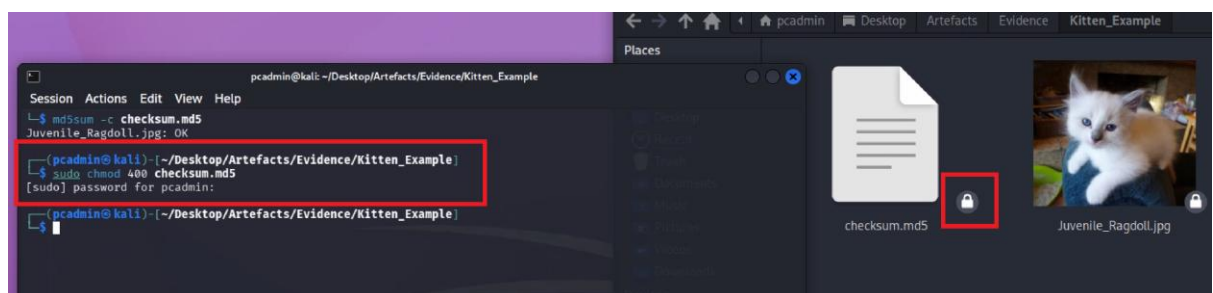
10. To check that the evidence is secure, we use this command to compare the hash of the evidence to the one we have stored in the checksum document.

```
(pcadmin@kali)-[~/Desktop/Artefacts/Evidence/Kitten_Example]
$ md5sum -c checksum.md5
Juvenile_Ragdoll.jpg: OK
```

The hash returned with an “OK” so it is safe.

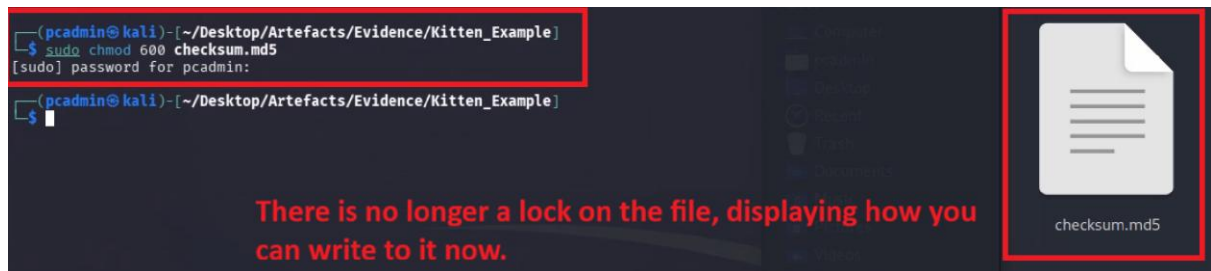
```
md5sum -c checksum.md5
```

11. Finally, change the evidence permissions on the checksum file to be read only. You need to change this back to read and write every time you want to add something new to it – refer to step 12 to do this. Do not make multiple checksum files for evidence that is within the same project/file. Eg. every piece of evidence that would exist in the Kitten_Example directory would be placed into this checksum file but not stuff outside of it. That requires a new checksum file to be made.



```
sudo chmod 400 checksum.md5
```

12. To make the checksum file readable again, replace the number 400 in the command to '600' instead. 700 includes execute permissions but we don't need those since this is a text file.



The image shows a terminal window with a dark background. The prompt is `(pcadmin@kali) - [~/Desktop/Artefacts/Evidence/Kitten_Example]`. The user enters `$ sudo chmod 600 checksum.md5`. The prompt changes to `[sudo] password for pcadmin:`, and the user's password is entered. The prompt returns to `(pcadmin@kali) - [~/Desktop/Artefacts/Evidence/Kitten_Example]`. To the right of the terminal, there is a file icon representing `checksum.md5`. Below the terminal output, a red text overlay reads: **There is no longer a lock on the file, displaying how you can write to it now.**

Full Command List below.

Command List

```
md5sum (filename)
```

Hash a file.

```
sudo chmod 400 (filename)
```

This is for changing a file to read only.

```
sudo chmod 600 (filename)
```

This for changing a file to read and write but not execute.

```
ls -lh
```

Displays all files in a directory with their expanded rwe permissions.

```
md5sum Juvenile_Ragdoll.jpg > checksum.md5
```

Inserts the hash of a file into the file in which we use to store and compare hashes.

```
md5sum -c checksum.md5
```

Compares the hash stored in the checksum file to all the hash of the original evidence.